than the application of the majority's decisions and the citizens' rights. Previously acquired rights enshrined in the Constitution, such as the right to housing, are progressively being eroded on the grounds that they impede the freedom of the market and therefore restrict economic development and modernisation (Dagnino 2010). This is especially evident in the city's favelas. The word *remoção* ('removal') which was broadly used during the military dictatorship is once again back on the agenda. Forty thousand are threatened by removal in Rio alone because of large-scale construction projects connected to the mega-events. The majority are poor favela residents.

Vila Autódromo, a fishing village which developed into a working-class neighbourhood in the upper-middle-class boomtown Barra de Tijuca in the western zone, serves as an example of the conflictual relationship between local residents and the government because of the upcoming mega-events. It is threatened by collective relocation because of the construction of the main sports arenas and accommodation centres for the 2016 Olympic Games (see Braathen et al. 2013). While the government, after massive pressure from residents and civil society organisations, has promised to consider an alternative plan where part of the community can remain, civil society actors claim the municipality is still using extra-juridical measures to force residents to accept relocation. Another community impacted by the ongoing city 'improvements' is the favela complex Manguinhos, located in abandoned factory areas. Since being selected for the PAC programme in 2008, a brutal, drawn-out eviction process has affected the community. The authorities have strategically employed an expulsion tactic where they demolish some houses and leave the ruins and, with them, garbage, rats and hazardous conditions behind. This makes life unbearable for those residents who remain, while sending a strong message that their eviction is imminent (Braathen et al. 2013).

These cases exemplify clearly how the 'benefits' and 'legacy' of the mega-events that the constructors promote can be imposed at the expense of poor communities and residents located near the sports facilities and the main access roads. Replacement housing being constructed through the federal housing programme MCMV has overwhelmingly been located in the distant northwest of the city, where land values are cheap, employment opportunities are limited and transport connections are poor. Studies by urban planners indicate that the MCMV programme reproduces the logic of older 'housing estates' where the poor end up being pushed to locations far from job opportunities and without a system of transportation (Braathen et al. 2013). These people's institutional rights have had to give way to the prosperity of society in general, defined within a